

1. Asimov's three laws are merely a suggestion

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/asimov-three-laws-dont-work-with-ai?src=feed>

Asimov's Three Laws of Robotics were designed as universal constraints for any thinking machine powerful enough to harm us: A robot may not injure a human being or, through inaction, allow a human being to come to harm. A robot must obey the orders given it by human beings except where such orders would conflict with the First Law. A robot must protect its own existence as long as such protection does not conflict with the First or Second Law. On paper, the logic is flawless. You could even express it as a function: `func isAsimovCompliant(willAllowHarmToHuman bool, ...) bool { if willAllowHarmToHuman { return false } ... return true }` The main property of this function is that it is a hard constraint. No matter what input you feed the system, the law either permits or forbids the action deterministically, every time. The rules don't bend. We don't have humanoids walking among us just yet, despite Elon's promises. But we have modern generative AI. Our guardrails are delivered as system prompts, text prepended to every conversation before you type a word. They might say "be helpful," "don't produce harmful content," or even "follow Asimov's Three Laws." The problem is that these ins...

2. Live blog: Code w/ Claude 2026

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-06T15:58:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/6/code-w-claude-2026/#atom-everything>

I'm at Anthropic's Code w/ Claude event today. Here's my live blog of the morning keynote sessions. Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , anthropic , claude , claude-code , live-blog

3. Vibe coding and agentic engineering are getting closer than I'd like

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-06T14:24:08+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/6/vibe-coding-and-agentic-engineering/#atom-everything>

I recently talked with Joseph Ruscio about AI coding tools for Heavybit's High Leverage podcast: Ep. #9, The AI Coding Paradigm Shift with Simon Willison . Here are some of my highlights, including my disturbing realization that vibe coding and agentic engineering have started to converge in my own work. One thing I really enjoy about podcasts is that they sometimes push me to think out loud in a way that exposes an idea I've not previously been able to put into words. Vibe coding and agentic engineering are starting to overlap A few weeks after vibe coding was first coined I published Not all AI-assisted programming is vibe coding (but vibe coding rocks) , where I firmly staked out my belief that "vibe coding" is a very different beast from responsible use of AI to write code, which I've since started to call agentic engineering . When Joseph brought up the distinction between the two I had a sudden realization that they're not nearly as distinct for me as they used to be: Weirdly though, those things have started to blur for me already, which is quite upsetting. I thought we had a very clear delineation where vibe coding is the thing where you're not looking at the code at all....

4. llm-echo 0.5a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-05T01:31:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/5/llm-echo/#atom-everything>

Release: llm-echo 0.5a0 New -o thinking 1 option to help test against LLM 0.32a0 and higher. This plugin provides a fake model called "echo" for LLM which doesn't run an LLM at all - it's useful for writing automated tests. You can now do this: `uvx --with llm==0.32a1 --with llm-echo==0.5a0 llm -m echo hi -o thinking 1` This will fake a reasoning block to standard error before returning JSON echoing the prompt. Tags: llm

5. Why not have changes in API behavior depend on the SDK you link against?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260506-00/?p=112303>

Static libraries don't stand a chance. The post Why not have changes in API behavior depend on the SDK you link against? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. Broadcast Booths Around Baseball Tip Their Caps to John Sterling

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-06T20:33:51Z

Link:

<https://www.mlb.com/news/broadcast-booths-around-baseball-mirror-john-sterling-signature-calls>

Great stuff around MLB: Those around the league quickly honored that legacy during Monday night's slate of games. Tributes rolled in from across the league, with various play-by-play announcers deviating from their typical routines to give a nod to Sterling's distinct style. It started with the Yankees and TV man Michael Kay, who called Aaron Judge's first-inning home run exactly as Sterling would have: "It is high, it is far, it is gone!" Kay said, continuing: "Aaron Judge, a Judgian blast! Here comes the Judge!" The Yankees also tipped the cap to Sterling by playing a recording of his iconic post-win call over the loudspeakers in Yankee Stadium once New York wrapped up a 12-1 win over the Orioles. "Yankees win, theeee Yankees win!" something Judge and manager Aaron Boone each said they hoped could continue to be done moving forward. The Yankees will wear a commemorative patch for the remainder of the season. I've got my beefs with Hal Steinbrenner, but the organization still knows how to do stuff like this right. Sterling called 5,426 regular-season Yankees games and 225 postseason games. According to this tally, there are only three teams that have even played in at least...

7. Claris CEO Ryan McCann on FileMaker in the Age of Agentic Coding

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-06T19:41:36Z

Link: <https://www.claris.com/blog/2026/how-claris-is-building-for-what-comes-next>

That previous item led me to look at Claris's website for the first time in a while. And, lo, there's a banner promoting a message from CEO Ryan McCann that was posted just yesterday, under the headline "How Claris Is Building for What's Next": Every AI-generated application creates the same problems: Where does it run, and how is it deployed, secured, and managed? The app needs a database. It needs user authentication, role-based permissions, and audit logging. It needs backup and recovery. It needs to work on Mac, Windows, iPad, iPhone, and the web. It needs to run on infrastructure your organization controls, whether that is in the cloud or on your own hardware. This is what FileMaker already is. One unified platform with data, logic, interface, security, and cross-platform delivery, built together from the start. We've been solving this problem at scale for over 40 years. "Mac, Windows, iPad, iPhone, and the web?", huh? Feels like there's a somewhat popular platform missing from that list. Can't quite put my finger on it. Oh yeah. FileMaker 2026 is coming soon. This release focuses on resiliency, productivity, and infrastructure, including native disaster recovery and busine...

8. Luca Maestri Runs the Cafeteria

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-06T19:29:08Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/leadership/luca-maestri/>

Apple Newsroom, back in August 2024: Apple today announced that Chief Financial Officer Luca Maestri will transition from his role on January 1, 2025. Maestri will continue to lead the Corporate Services teams, including information systems and technology, information security, and real estate and development, reporting to Apple CEO Tim Cook. As part of a planned succession, Kevan Parekh, Apple's Vice President of Financial Planning and Analysis, will become Chief Financial Officer and join the executive team. That continued leadership role wasn't ceremonial. Maestri still has an executive page, which reads: Luca Maestri is Apple's vice president of Corporate Services, reporting to CEO Tim Cook. In this role, he oversees a range of functions, including information systems and technology, information security, real estate and development, Caffè Macs, and Claris. I find the mention of Caffè Macs to be utterly charming. (And the mention of Claris to be at least a little interesting.)

9. Splitting up my .emacs, or "use-package doesn't solve all problems"

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-06T02:42:27Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsSplittingMyInitFile>

Over on the Fediverse, I shared a little story : The current state of my GNU Emacs yak shaving: ; wc -l .emacs 1550 .emacs Some of that is comments. Some of that is personal functions that I should move out to other files so I can have only use-package stuff in my .emacs. And some of it is large blocks for lsp-mode and company and some other stuff I'm probably never going to use again, which I should drop. I got into my .emacs situation despite using use-package , which is the usual way people recommend to tame your Emacs configuration. Today I dealt with the whole thing by splitting my .emacs up into separate files , which is much better in general even if it's a bit more annoying in some ways. My .emacs had accumulated a number of things over time, probably like many long term Emacs users. Besides infrastructure for use-package, it also had general Emacs settings I want, little personal commands and functions, simple use-package declarations, and a number of large, complex use-package declarations for packages that I need to significantly customize and tweak (and where I had lots of comments about the situation, written for my future self). Plus it also had commented out remains...

10. Triangular analog of the squircle

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 19:53:29 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/06/triangular-analog-of-the-squircle/>

TimF left a comment on my guitar pick post saying the image was a ?squircle-ish analog for an isosceles triangle.? That made me wonder what a more direct analog of the squircle might be for a triangle. A squircle is not exactly a square with rounded corners. The sides are continuously curved, but curved most [?] The post Triangular analog of the squircle first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Unified config files

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 16:32:20 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/06/unified-config-files/>

I try to maintain a consistent work environment across computers that I use. The computers differ for important reasons, but I'd rather they not differ for unimportant reasons. Unified keys One thing I do is remap keys so that the same key does the same thing everywhere, to the extent that's practical. This requires remapping [?] The post Unified config files first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. The mythology of category theory

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 11:37:42 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/06/category-mythology/>

Yesterday a friend and I had a conversation about category theory, how it can be a useful pattern description language, but also about how people have unrealistic expectations for it, believing category theory can deliver something for nothing. Later I ran across the following post from Qiaochu Yuan. It felt as if he had overheard [?] The post The mythology of category theory first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Revisiting the 2015 Open Source Census

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-06T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/06/revisiting-the-2015-open-source-census.html>

In July 2015, a year after Heartbleed, the Linux Foundation's Core Infrastructure Initiative published a census of open source projects . The idea was to find the next OpenSSL before it found us: take every package in Debian's popularity contest, score it for risk, and produce a ranked list of where to send help. David Wheeler designed the scoring, a small team did manual review, and the output was a CSV of 428 projects sorted by a risk_index from 1 to 13. I'd forgotten it existed until Daniel Stenberg posted a ten-years-on reminder on Mastodon this week, linking back to his 2016 write-up . I was about nine months into building Libraries.io when the census came out. At the time I thought I was building a discovery engine, a way to find packages across registries, and it took a few more years to notice that the dependency

graph I'd accumulated was more useful for sustainability and security questions than for search. So I remember reading the census results and then, like most people, not thinking about them again. The data is still there, untouched since 2016. Reading it now is an odd experience because you know how the next ten years went and the people filling in the spreadsheet...

14. Pluralistic: In praise of vultures (06 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 10:15:36

+0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/06/champerty-loves-company/>

Today's links In praise of vultures: They screw you because they can. Hey look at this:

Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Linus v MSFT; Argentina v MSFT; Danny Hillis on theme parks v games; Smartfilter v Distributed Boing Boing; Rental laptops filled with spyware;

Torture didn't help capture bin Laden; Massively parallel Apple //e; Stephen Harper v election

law; John Deere v Iowa cartoonist; Qualia. Upcoming appearances: Guelph, Barcelona, Berlin,

Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em.

Colophon: All the rest. In praise of vultures (permalink) One of my bedrock beliefs is that capitalists really hate capitalism. They may name their beloved institutes after the likes of Adam Smith, but they ignore everything Smith had to say about the necessity of competition to keep markets from turning into monopolies:

<https://pluralistic.net/2023/06/09/commissar-merck/#price-giver> The theory of capitalism holds that markets are a kind of distributed computer that aggregates trillions of decisions from billions of market participants in order to o...

15. New Logic for Programmers (and the future of this newsletter)

Source: Computer Things | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 17:03:46 +0000

Link:

<https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/new-logic-for-programmers-and-the-future-of-this/>

So first the immediate news: I just released version 0.14 of Logic for Programmers ! This release is pretty similar to 0.13. There are a few rewrites but the vast majority of the changes are layout, copyediting, and technical editing. Full notes here . In related news, I've started doing test prints of the book: There's not a whole lot left to be done. I've gotta fix up some diagrams, do more formatting and proofreading, incorporate some fixes raised by readers, and make a website and back cover. After that, the book should be ready for 1.0. I'm aiming to have print copies purchasable by the end of June! Now the big news: starting August, I'll be a full-time employee of Antithesis , a generative testing platform. Officially my role is "developer educator", and I'll be tasked with making "property-based testing, fuzzing, fault injection, Hegel , Bombadil , and the Antithesis platform understandable to everyday engineers". So the same kind of work I do now, except with far more support and a matching 401(k). I already have three pages of topic ideas you have no idea how excited I am about this So how is this going to affect the newsletter? First, I want to make clear that this is no...

16. Am I Meant To Be Impressed?

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 15:13:07 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/am-i-meant-to-be-impressed/>

If you liked this piece, please subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and OpenAI&

17. The war between fast and legitimate is here

Source: Westenberg. | Published: Thu, 07 May 2026 01:18:04 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenberg.com/the-war-between-fast-and-legitimate-is-here/>

The European Union spent four years drafting the AI Act, with OpenAI shipping GPT-4 to a hundred million users in two months. By the time Brussels finalised its definitions of

"high-risk" systems, the systems in question had moved twice and grown various new appendages.

The regulators were neither

18. Open weights are quietly closing up - and that's a problem

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/open-weights-are-quietly-closing-up/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

Open weights models keep frontier labs honest on price. If they disappear, we end up with a handful of oligopolists extracting consumer surplus.

19. Ingeniería inversa del código fuente de la vacuna de BioNTech/Pfizer para el SARS-CoV-2

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 29 Dec 2020 14:12:20 +0100

Link: https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/ingenieria_inversa_del_codigo_fuente_de_la_vacuna_de_biontech_pfizer_para_el_sars-cov-2/

Translations: ???????? / ?? / Deutsch / Français / Hrvatski / Italiano / ?????? / Polskie /

Português ¡Bienvenidos! En esta publicación daremos una mirada carÆcter por carÆcter al código fuente de la vacuna de ARNm de BioNTech/Pfizer al SARS-CoV-2. Quiero agradecer a la gran cantidad de personas que se tomaron el tiempo de revisar que este artículo sea legible y correcto. Todos los errores, sin embargo, continúan siendo míos,> pero me encantaría poder escuchar sobre ellos rÆpidamente en bert@hubertnet.

20. Een inkijkje in de broncode van het BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2-vaccin

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 29 Dec 2020 11:12:20 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/dutch-reverse-engineering-source-code-of-the-biontech-pfizer-vaccine/>

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21. Een inkijkje in de broncode van het BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2-vaccin

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22. SQLAlchemy 2 In Practice - Chapter 7: Asynchronous SQLAlchemy

Source: Miguel Grinberg's Blog | Published: Wed, 06 May 2026 21:49:20 GMT

Link: <https://blog.miguelgrinberg.com/post/sqlalchemy-2-in-practice---chapter-7-asynchronous-sqlalchemy>

This is the seventh chapter of my SQLAlchemy 2 in Practice book. If you'd like to support my work, I encourage you to buy this book, either directly from my store or on Amazon . Thank you! Starting with release 1.4, SQLAlchemy includes support for asynchronous programming with the asyncio package, for both the Core and ORM modules. This is an exciting improvement that brings the power of SQLAlchemy to modern applications such as those written with the FastAPI web framework.